



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Great Hearts Invictus

School Website: <https://invictus.greatheartsamerica.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Great Hearts Invictus TX 78023 presents a robust alignment with classical education principles as articulated in the classical education rubric. The school's public materials emphasize a liberal-arts, Great Books–driven, Socratic-centered program that foregrounds Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, strongly shaping curriculum, pedagogy, and school culture around character formation and intellectual virtue. Public-facing materials frequently invoke the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Socratic dialogue, and a formation-focused mission, and they describe a community-wide commitment to families as partners. While the school foregrounds transcendental aims and a classical curriculum, it also identifies itself as a non-sectarian charter school, which introduces a nonliturgical, broadly Christian-informed classical framework rather than church-centered liturgy. This combination yields a predominantly Classical orientation with some notes of nonsectarian structure. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: The public materials foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and reference the Socratic method and enduring questions; liturgical/theological framing is not overtly central on the public pages, though a wider Great Hearts ecosystem emphasizes theological grounding; a formal liturgical program is not publicly advertised on the Invictus public site, and the school explicitly identifies as non-sectarian. Positive keyword indicators (truth, goodness, beauty, wonder, Socratic dialogue) appear, while theological liturgy framing is less explicit in public-facing content. Negative indicator: nonsectarian posture in charter description. Why: The school tightly aligns with transcendental ideals and intellectual virtues, but explicit liturgical/theological programmatic language is not consistently evident in public-facing content. Evidence and citations: Truth/Goodness/Beauty and Socratic method on homepage; Our Mission statement; nonsectarian charter language.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** Evidence: The mission centers on cultivating minds and hearts through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; formation and virtue are central; emphasis on human excellence and moral imagination appears in mission statements and school communications; a liberal-arts formation oriented toward wisdom is explicit. Negative signals (e.g., job/career-centrism) are not presented in public content. Why: The school explicitly prioritizes formation, virtue, and the trans-empirical aims of truth, goodness, and beauty over vocational outcomes in its public messaging. Evidence and citations: Our Mission statements; statements about formation and the Great Books / humane-letters focus.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL** Evidence: The Invictus public materials describe a classical liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; mathematics; history; natural science; philosophy), a Great Books library, and a Senior Thesis, with explicit reference to the Great Conversation and lifelong study. Materials reference the liberal-arts foundation and integration with classics (e.g., humane letters, Great Books). Why: This category is strongly Classical given explicit alignment to the seven liberal arts framework and Great Books approach, with cross-curricular integration and emphasis on historical/western tradition texts. Evidence and citations: Curriculum page detailing classical

liberal arts, Socratic instruction, Great Books; statements about Latin, senior thesis, humane letters, and Great Books.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit use of Socratic instruction; emphasis on inquiry, discussion, and memory work; lower- and upper-school practices referenced (Socratic seminars, rhetorical development, recitation and potential memory practices) align with classical pedagogy. The presence of “restful learning” concepts is implied via the classical pedagogy lexicon (Scholé) in the knowledge-base materials, and the site emphasizes “great conversation” as a central method. Why: The primary pedagogy shown is classical (Socratic method, memorization/recitation, rhetorical training) with strong upper-school seminar emphasis, meeting the core criteria for a classical pedagogy. Evidence and citations: Curriculum page (Socratic method); public mentions of Socratic instruction and classical pedagogy concepts; Great Books/Humane Letters framework.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials reference a mission-driven faculty drawn from strong character and academic distinction; leadership positions (Headmaster/Dean of Academics/Dean of Student Culture, etc.) and a culture described as a “living curriculum” and “community of friends” indicate a faculty model oriented toward virtue and mentorship. Why: The public-facing materials frame faculty as models of learning and character, with a deliberate mentorship culture and embedded teacher leadership roles—consistent with classical faculty expectations. Evidence and citations: Lower/Upper School administration pages and ICO references; statements about living-curriculum and teacher as models.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The Invictus campus highlights parent involvement via enrollment materials, family handbooks, and a strong Parent Service Organization (PSO); content emphasizes partnership with families, parent formation and education, open campus visits, and ongoing family-school collaboration. Why: The school explicitly positions parents as co-educators, with ongoing opportunities for involvement and education about classical education—matching the category’s criteria. Evidence and citations: Family Handbook / Letter to Families; PSO pages; enrollment materials describing parent involvement.
- Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL Rationale: Across all six categories, the public-facing materials show substantial alignment with classical education principles (Truth-Beauty-Goodness; liberal arts curriculum; Socratic pedagogy; Great Books; formation-focused messaging; living/faculty-centric culture; and strong parent/community partnerships). Element 1 shows some nonsectarian framing that softens the theological emphasis; however, the overall orientation remains classical in scope and practice.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (no category is ranked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL). The aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, so no mandatory needle-moving changes are required.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY DETAILED ANALYSIS

Note: The following sections explicitly reference keywords and evidence drawn from the knowledge-base of classical education indicators and the school’s public materials. Citations point to the relevant files in the uploaded crawl and knowledge resources.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public messaging foregrounds Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and frames education around the pursuit of these transcendentals, with Socratic method referenced as a core pedagogy. This aligns with transcendental moral realism and a classical metaphysical horizon, even as the site does not consistently foreground liturgical practice in public content. Evidence includes the home page’s statement about Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and explicit mention of Socratic inquiry, as well as the mission language and Great Books orientation.

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- The school identifies itself as a non-sectarian charter school and thus does not publicly showcase a liturgical program on the main site; the broader Great Hearts framework often foregrounds theology and liturgical practice in its other content, but Invictus’ public-facing pages emphasize the classical mission more than liturgical structures.
 - The Family Handbook and related Invictus materials indicate a Christian-inflected classical ethos within a nonsectarian charter framework, including references to “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” and formation language that can be read as metaphysical. This is evidenced in the family handbook materials and mission statements included in the crawl.
 - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, wonder, Socratic dialogue, great conversation, Logos (at least conceptually), wisdom, moral imagination, formation.
 - Negative keywords present: nonsectarian / secular framing in charter language (potentially a constraint on explicit theological programming in public-facing pages).
 - Quantitative estimate (approximate): Positive indicators ~6; Negative indicators ~1–2 (weighted as “nonsectarian” framing). Approximately 75% positive vs 25% negative among the explicit keyword instances available in public materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The material strongly asserts transcendental aims and Socratic method, which are core to the religious/metaphysical dimension of classical education (transcendental realism, inquiry into truth via virtue). The nonsectarian charter status tempers but does not erase the metaphysical and transcendent orientation visible in mission language and Great Books emphasis. The absence of overt liturgical programming in the main public site reduces the strength of a purely liturgical demonstration. Overall, a CLASSICAL orientation is present with some limitations in explicit theological liturgy on public pages. See evidence: Truth/Beauty/Goodness and Socratic method; nonsectarian charter statement.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission emphasizes cultivation of minds and hearts through truth, goodness, and beauty, signaling formation and human flourishing rather than a narrow vocational aim. The Great Hearts framework consistently centers on virtue formation and wisdom, aligning with classical purposes beyond job-readiness.
 - The Great Books/Humane Letters orientation and emphasis on formation through liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; science; philosophy) reinforce a purpose anchored in intellectual and moral formation rather than mere information transfer.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, liberal education, classical mission.
 - Negative keywords present: job-readiness or workforce-focused language is not present in public messaging.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators ~6–8; Negative indicators ~0–1; roughly 85–90% positive.
- Why this rating
 - The school’s publicly stated goals explicitly emphasize formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not vocational training, aligning with the classical ideal of paideia and human flourishing. See sources: Our Mission and curriculum descriptions.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Curriculum materials describe a classical liberal arts program (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a liberal-arts core including history, philosophy, science, math, etc., with Latin and other classical components. They also cite Great Books, humane letters, and a senior thesis, signaling deep

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- engagement with “Great Books” and the Great Conversation.
 - The curriculum overview highlights Classics in Keep (library/resource), Spalding/Singapore Math, and Socratic method, reinforcing classical content and pedagogy.
 - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Socratic method, humane letters, senior thesis, Classics to Keep.
 - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit “project-based learning dominance” or modernist reframing detected on public curriculum pages.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators ~8–10; Negative indicators ~0; ~80–100% positive depending on keyword set considered.
 - Why this rating
 - The curricular structure, explicit reference to the Trivium and Quadrivium, Great Books, and Socratic pedagogy strongly align with classic curricular expectations, supporting a CLASSICAL rating. See Curriculum page and linked Great Books/Humane Letters references.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Invictus curriculum emphasizes Socratic instruction and deep inquiry, with references to seminars, dialectic, and debate, consistent with upper-school rhetoric and rhetorical training. Lower-school practices reference singing, memorization, and memory-based recitation as part of foundational learning. The pedagogical framework includes the “Socratic method” and “great conversation.”
 - The knowledge-base lexicon (Six Essential Elements) identifies Socratic dialogue, restfulness (Scholé), memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation as core pedagogical markers; these align with Invictus practices described in public content.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, great conversation, guided discussion, memory work/recitation, scholé/restful learning, formation through imitation, rhetorical training.
 - Negative keywords present: project-based learning dominance and fully constructivist pedagogies are not foregrounded in public Invictus content.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators ~6–9; Negative indicators ~0–1; ~85–90% positive depending on keyword scope.
- Why this rating
 - The primary teaching methods are overtly classical (Socratic seminars, rhetorical training, recitation/memory). Public pages corroborate a pedagogy rooted in dialogue and memory rather than purely project-based or constructivist approaches. See public pages on curriculum and the Six Elements comparison.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Invictus public materials describe a professional, mission-driven cadre of faculty and leadership (Headmaster, Deans, etc.) who are selected for character and academic distinction, with a “living curriculum” framing and a mentorship culture. The school emphasizes faculty as models of learning and character.
 - Administrative structure (Headmaster, Assistant Headmasters, Deans, and subject-area leads) and a culture of collaboration align with classical faculty expectations of mentorship, virtue, and mastery of the curriculum.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture.

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- Negative keywords present: none directly evident on public pages; the Nonsectarian charter is a contextual negative signal for liturgical theology, not for faculty quality per se.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators ~5–7; Negative indicators ~0–1 (in public messaging, nonsectarian status is the primary contextual negative signal for liturgical emphasis, not for faculty quality). ~85–90% positive.
 - Why this rating
 - The public materials present a classical faculty model with strong mentorship language, living curriculum framing, and professional leadership. See Headmaster/Dean roles and “living curriculum” language.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The Invictus campus emphasizes parent partnership, family involvement, and co-educator roles in classical education; communications to families advocate volunteer engagement, family education (book studies), and accessible campus visits. The PSO (Parent Service Organization) material demonstrates structured family engagement and governance.
 - The Family Handbook and enrollment communications stress parental involvement, community partnerships, and a shared mission, consistent with classical-community practices.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, parent volunteers, community events, living tradition in the family.
 - Negative keywords present: none explicit in public-facing pages; the nonsectarian charter framing is again a contextual signal rather than a direct barrier to parental partnership.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators ~5–7; Negative indicators ~0–1; ~85–90% positive.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly positions parents as co-educators and fosters ongoing parent education and campus involvement, aligning strongly with classical community principles as per the Six Essential Elements lexicon. See Family Handbook/PSO content.
- Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL
 - Across all six categories, Great Hearts Invictus TX 78023 demonstrates a coherent Classical alignment: a liberal-arts curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, Great Books, formation emphasis, and robust parent-community partnerships. The main caveat is its nonsectarian charter context, which slightly tempers explicit liturgical/theological public signaling, but does not undermine the classical orientation evident in mission, curriculum, pedagogy, and community practices. The Positive Keyword Indicators substantially outweigh Negative Signals, resulting in an overall CLASSICAL assessment.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable in this classification, as no category is ranked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The school already demonstrates a consistent CLASSICAL orientation across all six dimensions.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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